

HOUSE RESOLUTION 201

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A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Bill McCabe on the celebration of his eightieth birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this legislative body should pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Bill McCabe is celebrating his eightieth birthday, a milestone to be commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, an esteemed environmental justice leader, Mr. McCabe has devoted his career to advocacy on behalf of the people and communities of Tennessee and southern Appalachia; and

WHEREAS, born in Charleston, West Virginia, in 1946, Bill McCabe was raised in Kanawha County, where his early experiences in an industrial environment helped shape his awareness of the relationship between communities and the natural world; and

WHEREAS, he attended the University of South Carolina, where he began his lifelong commitment to public service and civic engagement through involvement in student organizing and efforts addressing issues of national and social importance; and

WHEREAS, after devoting sixteen years to teaching high school social studies, Mr. McCabe went on to serve as a union organizer for teachers' associations in West Virginia, Mississippi, and Missouri, advocating for educators and strengthening his commitment to community-based organizing and public service; and

WHEREAS, upon his retirement from union organizing, Mr. McCabe returned to West Virginia, where he became involved in efforts to address mountaintop removal mining, including work with the Ohio Valley Environmental Council, and he was later hired by the Citizens Coal Council as a part-time organizer; and

WHEREAS, in 2004, he joined the Sierra Club as an environmental justice organizer, working throughout the coalfields of southern Appalachia, including communities in Tennessee, where he became a respected and influential voice in regional environmental advocacy; and

WHEREAS, Bill McCabe has distinguished himself as a leader in efforts to address mountaintop removal mining and its effects on Appalachian communities, helping to bring attention to issues of environmental degradation, public health, and community well-being; and

WHEREAS, through his work, he has played a vital role in building alliances between national organizations and grassroots activists, including those in Tennessee, fostering cooperation and strengthening local efforts to protect communities and natural resources; and

WHEREAS, even beyond his formal professional roles, Mr. McCabe has continued to offer mentorship and support to those engaged in environmental justice and community advocacy, demonstrating a lifelong dedication to service; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize Bill McCabe for his dedicated service to the people of Tennessee on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and congratulate Bill McCabe on the celebration of his eightieth birthday and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.